

■■■ TINQUEST RPG ■■■

A Solo RPG Adventure in an Altoids Tin

Complete Rules & Reference Guide

INTRODUCTION

TinQuest RPG is a complete solo roleplaying game that fits in an Altoids tin. Using just 10 business card-sized game cards, 2 dice, and a mini pencil, you can embark on epic adventures in fantasy or cyberpunk settings. This game uses simple d6-based mechanics and an oracle system to create dynamic, emergent stories.

What You Need:

- 10 game cards (generated from the campaign builder)
- 2 mini d6 dice (different colors recommended)
- Mini pen or golf pencil
- An Altoids tin (optional, for portability)

CORE MECHANICS

Action Roll (1d6)

Whenever you attempt something risky or challenging, roll 1d6 and add modifiers:

Roll	Result
1-2	Failure - Things go wrong or get worse
3-4	Partial Success - You succeed but with a cost or complication
5-6	Success - You accomplish what you set out to do

Modifiers:

- **+1** if you have a relevant skill
- **-1** if you're wounded (Health $\leq$ 2)
- Spend 1 Resource to reroll the die

The Oracle (1d6)

When you need to answer yes/no questions about the world, consult the Oracle by rolling 1d6:

Roll	Answer
1	No, and... (adds a complication)
2-3	No
4-5	Yes
6	Yes, and... (adds a bonus or advantage)

CHARACTER STATS

Health (HP)

You start with 6 Health. When you take damage, mark off HP boxes on your character card. If you reach 0 HP, your character dies and the campaign ends. You are considered 'wounded' when you have 2 or fewer HP remaining (apply -1 to all action rolls).

Resources

You start with 6 Resources. These represent supplies, luck, determination, or equipment. You can spend Resources to:

- **Reroll** any die roll
- **Heal 2 HP** (representing rest, medical attention, or potions)
- **Gain advantage** on a narrative situation

Progress

You need 12 Progress to complete your quest. Gain Progress by completing quest objectives, defeating major threats, or making significant story breakthroughs. Track Progress on your character card using the checkbox track.

COMBAT

Combat is resolved using opposed rolls. You and your enemy both roll dice to determine the outcome.

Your Turn:

1. **Roll an action** to attack (1d6 + modifiers)
2. On a success (5-6), deal **1 damage** to the enemy
3. On a partial success (3-4), choose: deal 1 damage OR avoid the enemy's attack
4. On a failure (1-2), your attack misses

Enemy Turn:

Roll 1d6 for the enemy's attack:

- **1-3:** Miss - The enemy's attack fails
- **4-5:** Hit - Take 1 damage
- **6:** Critical Hit - Take 2 damage (or Boss damage listed on card)

Fleeing Combat:

You can attempt to flee by rolling an action. On a success, you escape. On a partial success, you escape but take 1 damage or lose 1 Resource. On a failure, you're still in combat and the enemy attacks.

ENCOUNTERS

Encounters represent enemies, hazards, or challenges you face during your quest. Each encounter card shows the threat's stats, special abilities, and loot drops.

Threat Level	HP	Hit On	Damage	Notes
Weak	2	4+	1	Minor threats
Standard	4	4+	1	Average enemies
Tough	6	3+	1	Dangerous foes
Boss	10	3+	2	Major villains

Special Abilities:

Each encounter has a special ability that makes it unique. Read the encounter card carefully and apply these abilities during combat. Examples include regeneration, armor, poison, or first strike capabilities.

Loot Tables:

When you defeat an encounter, roll 1d6 on the loot table on the back of the encounter card. You might find weapons, armor, resources, or quest-related items. Write new items in the inventory section of your character card.

QUEST SYSTEM

Quests are the main storyline of your campaign. Your quest card lists objectives that must be completed to finish the quest and win the game.

Quest Objectives:

Each quest has 3-7 objectives depending on its length (short, medium, or long). Objectives are narrative goals that guide your adventure. As you complete each objective, check it off on your quest card and gain 1-2 Progress.

Quest Length:

- **Short Quest:** 3 objectives (1-2 sessions)
- **Medium Quest:** 5 objectives (2-4 sessions)
- **Long Quest:** 7 objectives (4-6 sessions)

Interpreting Objectives:

Quest objectives are intentionally open-ended. Use the Oracle and random events to determine how you approach each objective. For example, 'Find the ancient temple' could involve tracking clues, negotiating with NPCs, exploring wilderness, or defeating guardians.

HOW TO PLAY

1. Setup

- Generate and print your 10-card campaign set
- Cut cards along the perforations
- Gather 2 d6 dice and a writing implement
- Place everything in an Altoids tin for portability

2. Starting Your Campaign

- Review your character card - note your skills and starting gear
- Read your quest card to understand your main objective
- Look at your encounter cards to know what threats await
- Begin by describing your character's starting situation

3. Playing a Scene

A typical scene follows this structure:

1. **Frame the scene:** Where are you? What are you trying to do?
2. **Ask questions:** Use the Oracle to establish details
3. **Take action:** Roll when attempting something risky
4. **Resolve consequences:** Apply damage, gain progress, or adjust the story
5. **Update cards:** Track HP, Resources, Progress, and notes

4. Using the Grid Map

The grid map card (1cm squares) is useful for tracking dungeon layouts, tactical combat, or mapping unexplored areas. Draw simple sketches to remember where you've been and what you've found.

5. Ending a Session

- Mark the session date on your utility card
- Write a brief summary in your notes
- Record any NPCs, locations, or important info on the tracker card
- Store all cards in your tin for next time

RANDOM EVENTS

When you're unsure what happens next or want to add unpredictability, roll on the random events table:

Roll	Event Type	Description
1	Danger/Hostile	An enemy appears or situation becomes threatening
2	Obstacle	A complication or barrier blocks your progress
3	Discovery	You find something useful or learn new information
4	NPC (Neutral)	You encounter a character who may help or hinder
5	Opportunity	A chance to gain an advantage or skip ahead
6	Breakthrough!	Major progress or a significant revelation

TIPS & STRATEGIES

Resource Management:

Resources are your lifeline. Don't hoard them - use them strategically to reroll crucial dice or heal when wounded. You can find more Resources through loot tables and quest rewards.

When to Fight vs Flee:

Not every encounter needs to be a battle. Consider fleeing from tough enemies if you're low on HP or Resources. You can always return later when better prepared.

Using the Oracle Effectively:

Ask yes/no questions to develop the story organically. Good examples: 'Is there a hidden entrance?' 'Does the NPC trust me?' 'Is the path ahead dangerous?' Let the Oracle surprise you!

Narrative Freedom:

The rules are guidelines, not restrictions. If something makes sense narratively, do it. The goal is to tell an engaging story and have fun, not to follow rules perfectly.

Track Everything:

Use your notes card, utility tracker, and quest notes liberally. Future you will appreciate remembering that NPC's name or where that secret door was located.

EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Here's a short example showing how the mechanics work in practice:

Scene: Entering the Goblin Camp

You are Kira, a Rogue with Stealth and Diplomacy skills. You've tracked the goblin raiders to their forest camp. Your current objective is to scout the camp without being detected.

You: 'I want to sneak to the edge of the camp to see how many goblins there are.'

Action: Roll 1d6 for stealth. You have the Stealth skill, so +1.

Roll: You roll a 3. With your +1 skill bonus, that's a 4 - Partial Success!

Result: You successfully reach the camp's edge, but you knock over a stick. Roll the Oracle: 'Does a guard hear me?' You roll a 2 (No). The guard is distracted and doesn't notice.

You: 'How many goblins do I see?'

Oracle: 'Are there more than 5 goblins?' Roll = 5 (Yes). You count at least 6 goblins.

You: 'I decide to wait until nightfall. When it's dark, I sneak into the camp.'

Action: Roll 1d6 for stealth (+1 skill). You roll 5 + 1 = 6. Success!

Result: You slip past the drowsy guards and reach the center of camp. Check off objective 1 on your quest card and gain 2 Progress!

CARD REFERENCE

Your 10-Card Set Includes:

1. **Character Card** - Your stats, skills, gear, and tracking spaces
- 2-5. **Encounter Cards (4)** - Enemies with stats and loot tables
6. **Quest Card** - Your main objectives and quest notes
7. **Title Card** - Campaign information and notes space
8. **Grid Map Card** - 1cm grid for drawing maps
9. **Quick Reference Card** - Core rules and random tables
10. **Utility Card** - Session tracker and NPC/treasure log

Printing Instructions:

- Use Avery 5371 business card stock (10 cards per sheet)
- Print at 100% scale (Actual Size)
- For double-sided: Print page 1 (fronts), flip on long edge, print page 2 (backs)

- Separate cards along perforations

CREDITS & LICENSE

TinQuest RPG was designed as a portable, accessible solo RPG system. The game is provided as-is for personal use. Feel free to modify, share, and adapt for your own campaigns.

Campaign cards are generated using the TinQuest Campaign Builder web tool. Create custom campaigns with different character classes, quests, and encounters for endless replayability.

CHARACTER CREATION

To create your character, choose a setting (Fantasy or Cyberpunk) and select a class. Each class has predefined skills and starting gear.

FANTASY CLASSES

Class	Skills	Starting Gear
Warrior	Combat, Survival	Longsword, Shield, Chainmail armor, Healing potion
Rogue	Stealth, Diplomacy	Daggers (2), Lockpicks, Leather armor, Grappling hook
Mage	Magic, Knowledge	Spellbook, Staff, Robes, Arcane focus
Ranger	Survival, Combat	Bow & arrows, Hunting knife, Leather armor, Rope (50ft)
Cleric	Magic, Diplomacy	Mace, Holy symbol, Chainmail, Healing herbs
Bard	Diplomacy, Knowledge	Rapier, Lute, Fine clothes, Disguise kit

CYBERPUNK CLASSES

Class	Skills	Starting Gear
Netrunner	Hacking, Tech	Cyberdeck, Neural interface, ICE breaker, Encrypted commlink
Solo	Combat, Streetwise	Smart pistol, Monofilament blade, Armored jacket, Tactical visor
Fixer	Streetwise, Persuasion	Concealed pistol, Credstick (3 Resources), Designer suit, Contact list
Techie	Tech, Combat	Multi-tool, Repair drone, Tool kit, Modified SMG
Medtech	Tech, Persuasion	Medkit (+2 healing uses), Stim injector, Surgical tools, Light pistol
Rockerboy	Persuasion, Streetwise	Charismatic presence, Amplifier implant, Stylish outfit, Holdout pistol

ENCOUNTER REFERENCE

Select 4 encounters for your campaign from the lists below. Mix threat levels for variety.

FANTASY ENCOUNTERS

Weak Threats (2 HP, Hit 4+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Goblin Scout	Rusty dagger	Cowardly: flees at 1 HP
Giant Rat	Diseased bite	Disease: -1 to next roll
Skeleton	Bone club	Undead: immune to fear
Wild Dog	Vicious bite	Pack hunter: +1 if multiple

Standard Threats (4 HP, Hit 4+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Orc Warrior	Battle axe	Rage: +1 dmg when below 2 HP
Shadow Stalker	Shadow blade	First strike: attacks before you
Dire Wolf	Savage maul	Trip: you need 5+ to flee
Bandit	Sword & crossbow	Ranged: can attack while fleeing

Tough Threats (6 HP, Hit 3+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Troll	Massive claws	Regeneration: heals 1 HP per round
Dark Knight	Cursed greatsword	Armor: first hit does 0 damage
Fire Elemental	Flame burst	Burning: 1 dmg per round in melee
Wyvern	Claws & poison tail	Poison: -1 to all rolls for 3 rounds

Boss Threats (10 HP, Hit 3+, 2 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Ancient Dragon	Fire breath & claws	Flight: requires Magic/ranged to hit
Lich Lord	Death magic	Life drain: heals 1 HP when damaging you
Giant King	Colossal hammer	Earthquake: AOE, hard to dodge
Demon Prince	Hellfire & claws	Summon minions: spawns weak enemies

CYBERPUNK ENCOUNTERS

Weak Threats (2 HP, Hit 4+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Street Punk	Knife & attitude	Backup: may call for help
Security Drone	Taser	Hovering: hard to hit with melee
Gangbanger	Pistol	Reckless: 5+ hits, but exposed
Malfunctioning Bot	Sparking cables	Erratic: roll twice, use lower

Standard Threats (4 HP, Hit 4+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Corporate Guard	SMG burst	Tactical training: 3+ to hit
Cyber Psycho	Mantis blades	Berserk: +1 dmg, can't flee
Combat Hacker	ICE attack	Quickhack: disables 1 cyberware
Gang Enforcer	Shotgun	Close range: 2 dmg at melee

Tough Threats (6 HP, Hit 3+, 1 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Cyborg Assassin	Smart weapons	Cloaking: first attack always hits
Rogue AI Fragment	System crash	Adaptive: learns from attacks
Heavy Mech	Chain gun	Armor plating: 3+ to damage it
Elite Soldier	Military rifle & grenades	Grenade: AOE damage

Boss Threats (10 HP, Hit 3+, 2 Dmg)

Name	Attack	Special Ability
Corporate Exec	Bodyguard team	Protected: must defeat guards first
Rogue AI	Network assault	Omnipresent: attacks from anywhere
Cyborg Warlord	Full body weaponry	Multi-attack: rolls twice per turn
Megacorp Security Chief	Advanced tech arsenal	Reinforcements: summons guards

QUEST REFERENCE

Choose one quest for your campaign. Each quest has objectives that guide your adventure.

FANTASY QUESTS

Quest	Type	Description
The Goblin Camp	Short (3)	Local goblins have been raiding farms
Lost Heirloom	Short (3)	A family heirloom was stolen by bandits
Haunted Crypt	Short (3)	Undead have risen in the old cemetery
The Dragon's Lair	Medium (5)	A dragon threatens the kingdom
The Lost Temple	Medium (5)	Ancient temple holds powerful artifact
The Dark Lord Returns	Long (7)	An ancient evil awakens

CYBERPUNK QUESTS

Quest	Type	Description
Data Heist	Short (3)	Steal corporate data from secure server
Gang Territory	Short (3)	A gang is threatening your neighborhood
Rogue AI	Short (3)	A malfunctioning AI is causing havoc
Corporate Espionage	Medium (5)	Infiltrate rival megacorp
The Cyberpsycho	Medium (5)	A rogue cyborg is on a rampage
Bring Down The Corp	Long (7)	Take down a corrupt megacorporation

BLANK CARD TEMPLATES

The following pages contain blank card templates you can print and fill in by hand if you prefer not to use the online generator. Print these pages on Avery 5371 business card stock.

Instructions:

1. Print the blank template pages on Avery 5371 card stock
2. Use the reference tables earlier in this document to choose your character, encounters, and quest
3. Fill in the cards using a pen, following the prompts on each card
4. Separate cards along perforations and assemble your campaign set

Blank Templates Include:

- Character Card (front and back)
- 4 Encounter Cards (fronts and backs with loot table)
- Quest Card (front and back)
- Title Card (front and back)
- Grid Map Card (pre-printed grids)
- Quick Reference Card (pre-filled with rules)
- Utility Card (pre-filled tracker)

Note: The Grid Map, Quick Reference, and Utility cards are the same for all campaigns and can be generated from the website or printed from the templates on the following pages.